



► BERETTA MODEL 1934

Date 1934

Origin Italy

Barrel 6in (15.2cm)

Caliber 9mm short

Pietro Beretta SpA (see pp.172-73) is the world's longest-established gunmaker. Its M1934 became the official Italian officer's side-arm during World War II. The design evolved from one executed two decades earlier. This recoil-operated weapon was restricted to firing a reduced-power round, originally in 7.65mm caliber.

► BERETTA 318

Date 1935

Origin Italy

Barrel 2½in (5.7cm)

Caliber .25in ACP

The Beretta Modello 318 was produced in Italy from 1935 to 1943. It was one of a developing line of Beretta small-frame pistols in .25in ACP caliber introduced in 1919, and it was exported in decent numbers to the US, where it sold under the name Bantam or Panther.



▲ BROWNING GP35

Date 1935

Origin Belgium

Barrel 4¾in (11.8cm)

Caliber 9mm Parabellum

Self-loading pistols were used only occasionally by special forces before the High Power (Grand Puissance) GP35 became the first self-loading pistol to be officially adopted into British service in 1954. It replaced the revolver as the official military sidearm in Britain. This model was the last Browning design.



▲ RADOM M1935

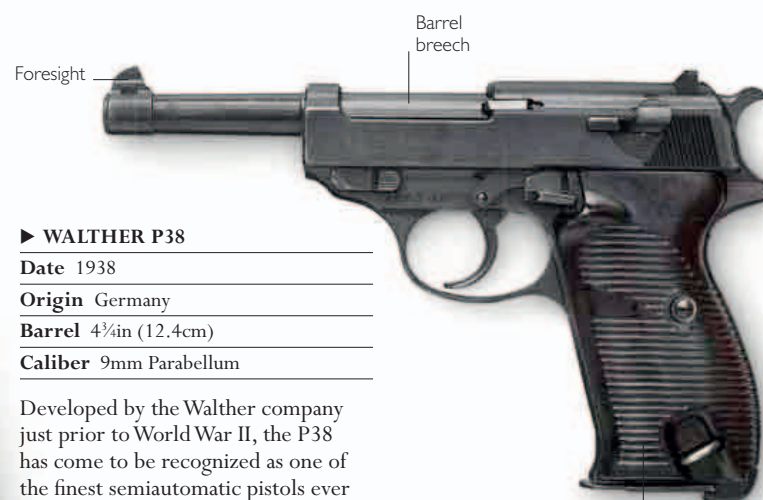
Date 1935

Origin Poland

Barrel 4½in (11.5cm)

Caliber 9mm Parabellum

The Radom was similar in concept to the Browning GP35 (left), but it was more compact and had extra security features. These included a decocking device that pulled the firing pin back and allowed the hammer to fall forward safely without firing the pistol.



► WALTHER P38

Date 1938

Origin Germany

Barrel 4¾in (12.4cm)

Caliber 9mm Parabellum

Developed by the Walther company just prior to World War II, the P38 has come to be recognized as one of the finest semiautomatic pistols ever designed. Simple in construction and ruggedly built, it proved to be reliable under all circumstances.

Grip made out of Bakelite, one of the early forms of plastic